others. This was the emergence of the first ‘Great Debate’ in IR in the post-World War II period.

The realist paradigm puts singular importance to states as the principal actors and their activities, guided by their interests to be the only reality. To the realists, conflict of interest is inevitable, which results in an anarchical international system and it is this situation of world politics that shapes the choices of the states where each state defines its interest in terms of power. Interest, defined in terms of power devoid of any moral consideration, according to the realist, gives meaning to international politics. Realism with its forceful exposition soon became the dominant paradigm of understanding IR. Nevertheless, dissatisfaction also arose about the shortcomings of the realist paradigm around 1960s and 1970s.

The discontent was more with the language and the method of studying IR. This was largely because of the behavioural revolution in the whole gamut of social sciences. The main emphasis was on application of scientific methods of study. Thus, emerged the second Great Debate in IR. But this ‘new’ Great Debate was different from the first in the sense that the first Great Debate was related to the subject matter or the content of IR, whereas the second was purely a methodological movement focusing on the mode of analysis in IR. As Kegley and Wittkopf[16] point out that the central focus was on “theorizing about theory” rather than “theorizing about international relations”. They tried to replace subjective belief with verifiable knowledge and wanted to supplant impressionism and intuition with testable evidence along with an endeavour to substitute data and reproducible information for mere opinion. The major works which tried to incorporate scientific methods were Quincy Wright’s *A Study of War*[*], Morton A. Kaplan’s *Systems and Processes in International Politics*[†] and Charles McClelland’s[‡] *Theory of the International System*.

The methodologies of theorists like Morton Kaplan and Karl Deutsch[§] repudiated the moralism and legalism of the traditional approaches. Kaplan conceived the international system as an “analytical entity” for explaining the behaviour of international actors and the “regulative”, “integrative” or disintegrative” consequences of